

Dionysus was one of the youngest Olympian gods. He was married to the mortal woman Ariadne, whom he took from Theseus when they were sailing back after killing the Minotaur. Always fond of a celebration, he was responsible for parties and theater, in addition to being the god of wine.

PARENTS: Zeus and Semele

CHILDREN: Many

SACRED SYMBOLS



THEATER

Theater was invented to be performed in honor of Dionysus.



BULL

The bull was Dionysus's favored animal, and he often had bull's horns.



GRAPES

Grapes are used to make wine. Dionysus was often seen with vines or a wine cup.



IVY

Dionysus's mother, Semele, strung ivy in her hair when she was pregnant.

WOMEN WORSHIPERS

Dionysus's most dedicated followers were known as maenads. These were women who dedicated themselves to the worship of Dionysus through drinking and dancing. In some tales, they descended into madness during their celebrations.

